PHP has a built-in function `parse_url()`, which will generate an associative array of URL components:

```
$url = 'https://www.cats.com:8080/nutters/jess?status=hungry#meow';
var_dump(parse_url($url));
```

```
Output:
array(6) {
  ["scheme"]=>
  string(5) "https"
  ["host"]=>
  string(12) "www.cats.com"
  ["port"]=>
  int(8080)
  ["path"]=>
  string(13) "/nutters/jess"
  ["query"]=>
  string(13) "status=hungry"
  ["fragment"]=>
  string(4) "meow"
}
```

You can also tell `parse_url()` to only return a specific component by adding a constant (such as `PHP_URL_QUERY`, `PHP_URL_HOST`, and so on) as a second argument:

```
var_dump(parse_url($url, PHP_URL_QUERY));
```

```
Output:
string(13) "status=hungry"
```

Constructing a URL from data like this is pretty straightforward:

```
$url = 'https://www.cats.com:8080/nutters/jess?status=hungry#meow';
$components = parse_url($url);
print $components['scheme'] . '://'
    . $components['host'] . ':'
    . $components['port']
    . $components['path'] . '?'
```